according to the CaaS model. Microsoft Azure Functions is a platform that provides cloud services following the FaaS model. At a lower level, if you deploy your applications directly on an Ubuntu machine, that will be your platform. In the rest of the book, whenever I use the term *platform*, I mean the broader concept just explained, unless specified otherwise.

1.3 Properties of cloud native applications

The scene is set: you are in the cloud. How should you design applications to take advantage of its characteristics?

The CNCF identifies five main properties that cloud native applications should have: scalability, loose coupling, resilience, observability, and manageability. Cloud native is a methodology for building and running applications that exhibit those properties. Cornelia Davis sums it up by stating that "cloud-native software is defined by how you compute, not about where you compute."[5] In other words, the cloud is about *where*, and cloud native is about *how*.

I have already covered the *where* part: the cloud. Let's go ahead and explore the *how*. For a quick reference, figure 1.4 lists the properties with short descriptions.